

Amendment No. 1 to HB0696

Farmer
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 1123

House Bill No. 696*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. This act is known and may be cited as the "Statewide Sexual Assault Response Team (SART) Coordinator Act."

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 38, Chapter 1, Part 9, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

38-1-904. Statewide SART coordinator.

(a) There is created a statewide sexual assault response team (SART) coordinator.

(b) The statewide SART coordinator is responsible for serving as a key resource to local sexual assault response teams and assisting teams in implementation of and compliance with § 38-1-903. The statewide SART coordinator must offer ongoing support to promote consistent and coordinated care for sexual assault victims throughout the state, foster communication and collaboration between sexual assault response teams statewide, promote best practices, and facilitate training and ongoing technical assistance.

(c) The statewide SART coordinator is an employee of the Tennessee Coalition to End Domestic and Sexual Violence and shall report directly to the executive director of the organization, or the executive director's designee.

(d)

(1) Subject to appropriations, the statewide SART coordinator position is funded by grants from the department of finance and administration, office of

criminal justice programs, to the Tennessee Coalition to End Domestic and Sexual Violence for such purpose. The sole purpose of a grant issued pursuant to this subsection (d) is to support the work of the statewide SART coordinator.

(2)

(A) Prior to receiving a grant pursuant to this subsection (d), the Tennessee Coalition to End Domestic and Sexual Violence must submit to the office of criminal justice programs a plan specifying the use of the grant funds. The plan must ensure that administrative costs are reasonable, allocable, and necessary to the statewide SART coordinator's role and include details regarding how the Tennessee Coalition to End Domestic and Sexual Violence will use grant funds to:

(i) Provide training, technical assistance, and support to local sexual assault response teams;

(ii) Ensure proper functioning of sexual assault response teams and their compliance with applicable laws; and

(iii) Provide an annual report to the office of criminal justice programs related to the activities undertaken by the SART coordinator.

(B) The plan must be approved by the office of criminal justice programs and included in the grant contract.

(e) Not later than February 1 annually, the statewide SART coordinator shall submit a report to the chief clerks of the senate and the house of representatives and the legislative librarian on the status of the SART program throughout the state, including training efforts, compliance levels, and recommendations for improvement. The coordinator shall also report on the effectiveness of SARTs in responding to sexual assault cases, identifying gaps in service, and addressing systemic challenges.

SECTION 3. The heading in this act is for reference purposes only and does not constitute a part of the law enacted by this act. However, the Tennessee Code Commission is requested to include the heading in any compilation or publication containing this act.

SECTION 4. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.